QP CODE: 25900193

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION MARCH 2025
SECOND SEMESTER
Multi-Disciplinary Course - MDC- MG2MDCSOC100 - CYBER WORLD AND SOCIAL REALITIES
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 Hours Maximum Marks: 35

Part A

Short Answer Type Questions
Answer any five questions. Each question carries 2 marks

1. Cyberspace refers to the virtual environment created by interconnected computer networks, particularly the internet, where online interactions and communication occur. **[K] [1].**

2. People curate online identities through personal branding, social validation, self-expression, audience expectations, personal goals, privacy concerns and carefully managing their digital image to control public perception.**[U] [2].**

3. Technology shapes moral values by influencing behaviors, norms, and interactions, both positively through empathy and knowledge-sharing and negatively via cyberbullying and privacy concerns, while also challenging traditional frameworks by exposing diverse perspectives and reshaping social norms through digital interactions. **[A] [3].**

4. Social media platforms are online services for creating, sharing, and interacting with content. Examples include Facebook, Twitter, and Instagram. Unlike email or messaging apps, they prioritize public or semi-public interactions. These platforms emphasize user-generated content and real-time social connections. **[U] [2].**

5. Digital identities create data trails that can be tracked, collected, and potentially misused, increasing vulnerability to privacy breaches, identity theft, and surveillance. **[E] [2].**

6. Yes, social media significantly influences political opinions and movements by facilitating information dissemination, mobilization, and discussion. It enables rapid spread of ideas, activism, and community-building around political causes, though it can also spread misinformation. **[U] [2].**

(5 × 2 = 10)

Part B

Short Essay Type Questions
Answer any two questions. Each question carries 5 marks.

7. Digital ethnography, also known as netnography or virtual ethnography, is a qualitative research method that adapts traditional ethnographic techniques to study online communities and cultures. Explores how technology mediates social relationships and cultural practices.

Provides insights into emerging digital cultures and online social norms. **[U] [2].**

8. Cyberbullying,Identity theft and digital fraud, Hate Speech , Trolling, Doxing (revealing private info without consent), Spreading Misinformation/Disinformation , Online Scams and Fraud, Grooming (manipulating minors online). **[K] [3].**

9. A term popularized by sociologist Manuel Castells, the network society describes a social structure where networks, powered by digital technologies, become the primary organizing principle of society. Interconnected Networks: Social, economic, and political activities occur in interconnected digital spaces. Decentralization: Hierarchical structures are replaced by more flexible and decentralized networks. Information as a Core Resource: Information and knowledge are critical for societal development. **[U] [1].**

10. Cryptojacking is a type of malware that uses a victim's computer to mine cryptocurrency. For individual users, it leads to reduced device performance, increased electricity costs, and potential hardware damage due to excessive resource consumption. Businesses face more severe consequences, including compromised network security, significant productivity losses, increased operational costs, and potential data breaches. **[An] [4].**

(2 × 5 = 10)

Part C

Essay Type Questions

Answer any one question. Each question carries 15 marks.

11. The cyber world and society are deeply and increasingly intertwined, forming a complex symbiotic relationship. **Social Interaction:** The cyber world provides platforms for communication, relationship building, and community formation, often transcending geographical boundaries. **Economy:** E-commerce, digital marketplaces, online banking driven by the cyber world. Businesses rely heavily on digital infrastructure for operations, marketing, and global reach. **Politics and Governance:** The cyber world is a crucial space for political discourse, mobilization, and information dissemination. Governments utilize digital platforms for service delivery and communication, while also facing challenges related to cybersecurity and online governance. **Culture and Identity:** Digital platforms shape cultural trends, facilitate the sharing of creative content, and influence identity formation and expression. **Education and Knowledge:** The internet provides unprecedented access to information and learning resources, transforming educational practices and democratizing knowledge acquisition. **Health and Wellbeing:** Digital connectivity impacts physical and mental health through healthcare technologies, information access, and changing lifestyle patterns. **Challenges:** This deep interconnectedness also presents challenges such as cybercrime, privacy

violations, the spread of misinformation, digital divides, and the potential for social isolation and mental health issues. **[U] [1].**

12. AI refers to computer systems designed to perform tasks that typically require human intelligence, including learning, reasoning, problem-solving, perception, and language understanding. **Societal Implications : Economy and Labor:** AI has the potential to automate tasks, increasing efficiency and productivity across industries. job displacement and the need for workforce retraining. New AI-related jobs. **Healthcare:** AI can revolutionize diagnostics, drug discovery, personalized medicine, and patient care, potentially leading to more effective and accessible healthcare. **Education:** AI can personalize learning experiences, provide intelligent tutoring systems, and automate administrative tasks.**Governance and Security:** AI can enhance public safety through surveillance and crime prediction, but also raises concerns about privacy. **Social Interactions:** AI-powered virtual assistants and social robots can impact human interaction and companionship. **Existential Risks:** While debated, some concerns exist regarding the long-term risks of advanced AI, including potential loss of human control. **[E] [2].**

(1 × 15 = 15)